THE NORTH LONDON INDEPENDENT GIRLS' SCHOOLS' CONSORTIUM

Group 2

YEAR 7
ENTRANCE EXAMINATION

ENGLISH

Friday 10 January 2014

Time allowed: 1 hour 15 minutes

First Name: .....

Surname: .....

READING RAW SCORE (out of 40)		SCALED READING		(mark out of 50)
		WRITING		(mark out of 50)
		TOTAL		%

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INSTRUCTIONS

PLEASE ANSWER BOTH PARTS OF THE PAPER

Part A: Reading (45 minutes)

- Spend 10 minutes reading the passage on the insert and the questions in this booklet.
- You may mark the passage by underlining words and phrases.
- Do not write anything in your booklet during this time.
- You will be told when the 10 minutes are over.

Spend 35 minutes writing your answers in this answer booklet

- You will be told when 45 minutes are up, but you may start Part B when you are ready.

Part B: Writing (30 minutes)

- Spend 30 minutes writing on the lined paper provided.
- Put your first name and surname at the top of each page.
- If you have time, you may go back to Part A.

YOU MAY WRITE IN EITHER INK OR PENCIL

You will be told when you have 5 minutes left.

READING PASSAGE

The morning wore on. Lilly couldn't believe that she had looked forward to the visit – crazy. Was it always like this when your big sister brought her college boyfriend home? Everything Jez did was just out of step, just off-key for their family. Alice should find someone better. Lilly had another mutinous grumble.

'Oh no, Mum, not a picnic. It's too hot!'

'Oh yes, Lilly, a picnic. I know, it's torture, isn't it? Dig the basket out for me, pet.'

She trailed off reluctantly. Jez was in the hall tickling Jumble's striped tummy – wants to show what a great guy he is, thought Lilly, and everyone's falling for it, including the dog. Traitor. 'Excuse *me*,' she said, wielding the picnic basket as she pushed past.

'Want a hand with that, sweetie?'

'No. And my name's Lilly. Unless you were referring to the dog.' He smiled up at her and she looked past him, determined not to meet his eye. They piled into the car. Mum let Jez sit in the front seat where he did all the talking with Alice leaning forward, face shining, laughing way too much. Mum parked on the verge and Jez commandeered the heavy basket. Greedy, too. Alice immediately fell in step with him and they walked ahead together, Jez with his long wavy ginger hair and stupid shorts, and Alice letting him put his freckly arm around her shoulder, smiling secret smiles. And Jumble was as bad, wagging his tail every time Jez looked at him. Mum had chosen a Best Walk, a real special, where the stream and canal were side by side and there was a magic picnic place that only their family knew about and came back to every summer, spending hours there, reading, snoozing, talking. Watching clouds. Why waste a Best Walk on a ginger stranger? Jez. Even his name was fake.

They dawdled, sitting on the lock wall, baking in the heat. Lilly stared at the ground, digging the toe of her sandal into the dust. 'I'm hungry,' she said. Like a 5 year old. They went to the stream next; as twisty as the canal was straight, weeping willows just touching its brown surface and reminding Lilly irritatingly of Jumble's tummy. And it was round the second bend that they saw them.

How beautiful swans are. They just floated, anchored in the middle of the swift current. One – father? mother? – headed the line, with five cygnets following on, and the second adult bringing up the rear; the perfect set-up. A happy family out on a beautiful summer day. Gives you hope, Lilly thought, that cygnets change so much, from grubby grey fluff – like what's left in the bag when Mum's finished hoovering – to a crisp spotless white.

They stopped to watch, a less unified family group. 'That third cygnet,' said Mum after a minute. 'What's coming out of its beak?'

‘Where? Oh yes – like garden twine or something.’ Alice moved closer. They could all see it now. Not only the green string but also a large lump halfway down, grotesquely distending the cygnet’s neck.

Lilly felt sick. ‘What can we do?’ she whispered, her mind whisking through suffocation, starvation, every painful death. She jumped to hear Jez’s voice from somewhere near her knees. Crouching down, he had edged silently to the bank.

‘We can’t do anything,’ he said. ‘It’d need a vet, and soon.’

‘But we can’t get it to a vet.’ Mum said what the three of them were thinking.

Jez turned his head to look at her. ‘Oh, I’ll catch it, if you don’t think it’s interfering.’

There was a pause. ‘Go on, then.’ Mum didn’t sound sarcastic but Lil heard it.

Just as he was, without even taking his smart trainers off, Jez walked down into the water and quietly approached the swans. The parent birds swam straight to meet him, putting their large strong bodies between this predator and their young. One of them reared up and lunged at Jez, wings spread at full stretch, hissing. Lil heard Alice squeak.

The swan hit Jez on the chest. He calmly gathered its body into his arms, hugging it almost, then turned it round and threw it gently downstream. Lilly waited for the next attack but it didn’t come. Jez moved towards the youngsters, water up to his waist now, and picked up the injured one, folding its wings close against its body. He waded back to the bank.

‘Give me a hand.’

Mum and Alice helped him clamber out. Lilly touched the cygnet, its cloudy grey softness at her head height. Its beak was open and it was panting.

‘It’s scared as well as hurt,’ said Jez. He quietly covered the bird’s eyes with his hand and then popped its head down the front of his T shirt. ‘Once it can’t see it’ll calm down.’ Good job it’s got such a long neck, thought Lilly. And as they watched, the grey body relaxed and the panting stopped.

‘What now?’ asked Mum in the silence. They all looked up at Jez.

‘The RSPCA have specialist vets,’ he said. ‘Perhaps that mill house would let us use their phone.’

Lilly went with Mum. The RSPCA van when it came was complete with a swan straitjacket that wrapped round the wings but left the head and neck outside. Ready for transit, thought Lilly. Just add postage.

They watched the van as it drove away, then carried on to their picnic spot. Lilly lay on the rug, thinking, shivering her eyelashes to make the sunlight tremble pink and orange. She’d been wrong: it wasn’t too hot for a picnic after all. She smiled up at the sky, eyes still closed. OK. Not a bad day, so far. She suddenly sat up, reached for the box of cakes and turned to Jez.

‘D’you want one?’ she asked. ‘I make these for Alice – she likes them best.’

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PLEASE TURN THE PAGE TO READ THE QUESTIONS

PART A: READING

After you have spent 10 minutes reading the passage, spend about 35 minutes answering these questions.

The mark at the end of each question is an indication of how much you should write for each answer.

1. Who is Alice and who is Jez?

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..... **2 marks**

2. What does 'wielding the picnic basket' (line 12) suggest?

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..... **2 marks**

3. The picnic place, lines 24–26: Lilly's family is described as 'spending hours there, reading, snoozing, talking. Watching clouds.' How does the use of punctuation here suggest a lazy atmosphere?

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..... **2 marks**

4. Re-read lines 3–27. What does Lilly dislike about Jez? Include a wide range of points.

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10 marks

5. What does the word ‘anchored’ in line 34 suggest about the appearance of the swans on the stream?

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3 marks

6. Why does the ‘happy family’ (line 37) of swans make such an impression on Lilly?

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6 marks

7. Write down five details from the passage which tell us that Jez is knowledgeable about animals.

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2: .....

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3: .....

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5: .....

..... **5 marks**

8. 'She'd been wrong' (line 82). What various things has Lilly learned that morning?

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(Continue writing over the page if you need more space)

8. contd.....

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..... **6 marks**

9. Why does Lilly offer Jez the box of cakes (line 84)?

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..... **4 marks**

Total marks for Reading Paper: 40

PART B: WRITING

INSTRUCTIONS:

Spend about 30 minutes on your writing.

Remember to leave time to check your work carefully.

Please write on the lined paper provided. Put your first name and surname at the top of each page.

What happens to the cygnet?

Continue the story.

50 marks

Total marks for Writing Paper: 50